MEETING OR CONTACT REPORT

	Date of Report: April 10, 1958
Organization & Location: Phone call from Los Alamos Scientific Laboratory to Poughkeepsie	Date: April 10, 1958
	Reported By: H. G. Kolsky
Project: STRETCH	Department: 749
	Follow-up Date:

PERSONNEL PARTICIPATING:
(Place asterisk next to those on distribution list. Other distribution show at end of report)

Bengt Carlson - LASL, Theoretical Division
H. G. Kolsky - IBM Product Planning

Mr. Bengt Carlson called me concerning another matter but our conversation drifted naturally to the STRETCH program. He mentioned two items which are perhaps worth recording:

(1) Mr. Carlson mentioned that Mr. Ed Voorhees had just returned from a meeting in New York City with Messrs. Johnston, Codd and Heising concerning the modified typewriter-card punch for use with the STRETCH system. He said that the Los Alamos people were quite happy that "IBM is finally going to do something in this area instead of talking and delaying." Bengt felt that the proposed system was "a very good beginning" although " we might want something more elaborate later." He re-itterated the LASL opinion that such a device was a necessity for future symbolic or automatic programming and that LASL would get such a device elsewhere if IBM did not furnish it.

(2) Mr. Carlson mentioned that he had received a letter from Mr. Norton of UCRL Livermore reporting briefly on the visit of IBM Marketing representatives to Livermore. In the letter Mr. Norton apparently said that it was extremely unlikely that IBM could meet their original goals and hinted at circuit difficulties and delays in delivery. Mr. Carlson

said he could not tell from the letter whether these statements were just Mr. Norton's opinions based on Livermore's LARC experiences or whether they reflected some real new information. Mr. Carlson was concerned as to whether there had been some set-back in the STRETCH program of which Los Alamos had not been informed. I tried to assure him that there was none such and that the project was proceeding nicely, etc.

I think this shows how easily rumors can start in this business.

HGK/jcv
cc: Mr. D. W. Sweeney
Mr. D. W. Pendery
Mr. J. J. Kenney, Jr.
Mr. S. W. Dunwell
Mr. E. F. Codd